



PAPUA NEW GUINEA

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 1 MAY 2026 - 30 MAY 2026

POLESTAR-ADVISORY.COM

DATA STATUS: MIXED SOURCES (LIVE, MANUAL & STATIC)

LATEST RECORD: 21 MAY 2026

LAST UPDATED: 23 MAY 2026

No relevant incidents were recorded in the 7-day window; this report uses the most recent 30-day context.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Papua New Guinea is a low-volume but high-friction operating environment. The 30-day window holds 30 records. The current-cycle reporting is dominated by urban violent-crime indicators out of Port Moresby and Lae, which is the practical concern for any staff or contractor footprint in the two main cities. The 30-day and 90-day context sections widen the lookback to keep route security, Highlands instability and resource-sector exposure in view; treat them as background risk rather than as live events. Reporting volume on PNG is genuinely thin most weeks, so the headline count should not be read as a measure of risk.

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 1 May - 30 May 2026	TOTAL RECORDS 30 Incidents in window	HIGHEST SEVERITY High Worst rating in window
MOST AFFECTED AREA Multiple locations	LATEST INCIDENT 21 May 2026	MAIN ISSUE TYPE Multiple issue types

SITUATION

Papua New Guinea is shaped by urban opportunistic crime in Port Moresby and Lae, inter-clan violence in the highlands, recurring resource-sector disputes and severe interior infrastructure limits. The 7-day window held no fresh records, so this read draws on the most recent 30-day window. The 30-day window holds 30 records. Treat these as the active operational signal. Records beyond the last 30 days sit in the 90-day background section below and should be read as deeper context.

WHAT HAPPENED

The most recent 30-day window points to armed robbery, security force operation and truck hijack in or around Port Moresby and Lae. That is the active signal. Anything beyond this week — including election-cycle unrest, fuel or port disruption, Highlands Highway incidents and Madang / Lae corridor events — sits in the 30 / 90-day context sections and should be read as background pattern rather than current activity.

WHAT MATTERS

The pattern is broad enough to act on. Port Moresby and Lae carry the clearest operational signal this cycle. Use it to prioritise journey management, site-access checks and pre-movement coordination in the affected sub-regions before broader posture changes.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Review movement plans for Port Moresby and Lae and refresh pre-movement briefings on the current incident types.
- Avoid predictable travel patterns around cash-handling sites, ATMs and end-of-shift cash runs.
- Check local security support is in place for any commercial site visit, including arrival / departure windows.
- Confirm journey management for staff and contractors, with a named on-call contact and a clear escalation path.
- Review road movement assumptions outside the main urban areas; default to air where the Highlands Highway is in play.
- Maintain flexible routing and a tolerance for delay; closures and protests can land at short notice.
- Confirm medical and evacuation arrangements for remote work, including the Cairns / Brisbane / Singapore medevac chain.

LOCATION WATCHLIST

LOCATION	NOTE	7D	30D	90D	WORST (90D)
Port Moresby	National Capital District, settlement-area crime focus	0	11	19	HIGH
Lae	Morobe province, port and Highlands Highway head	0	7	13	HIGH
Mount Hagen	Western Highlands, tribal-fight focal point	0	1	5	HIGH
Enga / Porgera	Tribal violence, Barrick / Zijin Porgera mine	0	1	4	EXTREME
Hela / PNG LNG	ExxonMobil PNG LNG upstream, landowner disputes	0	4	5	HIGH
Southern Highlands	Tribal fights, fuel-tanker ambush corridor	0	0	1	MODERATE
Bougainville	Post-referendum political transition	0	0	1	LOW
Highlands Highway	Ambush corridor between Lae and resource provinces	0	2	6	EXTREME
Lihir / Newmont Lihir	Lihir Island gold operation	0	0	0	No records
Ok Tedi	Western Province copper-gold mine	0	0	0	No records

30-DAY CONTEXT

Across the rolling 30-day context window Papua New Guinea carries 30 records, with 30 records sitting outside the current 7-day cycle.

BACKGROUND OPERATING PICTURE

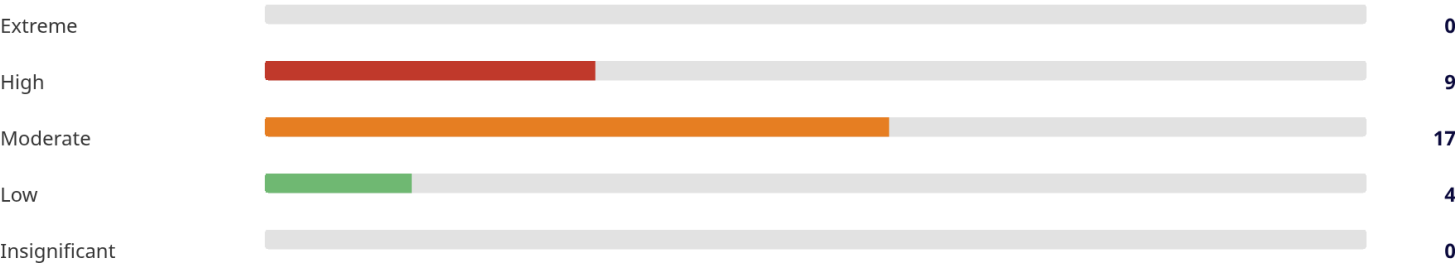
Across the rolling 90-day background window Papua New Guinea carries 60 records, 30 of which sit beyond the 30-day context. Use them to size the background operating picture rather than to direct current movement decisions.

MAP

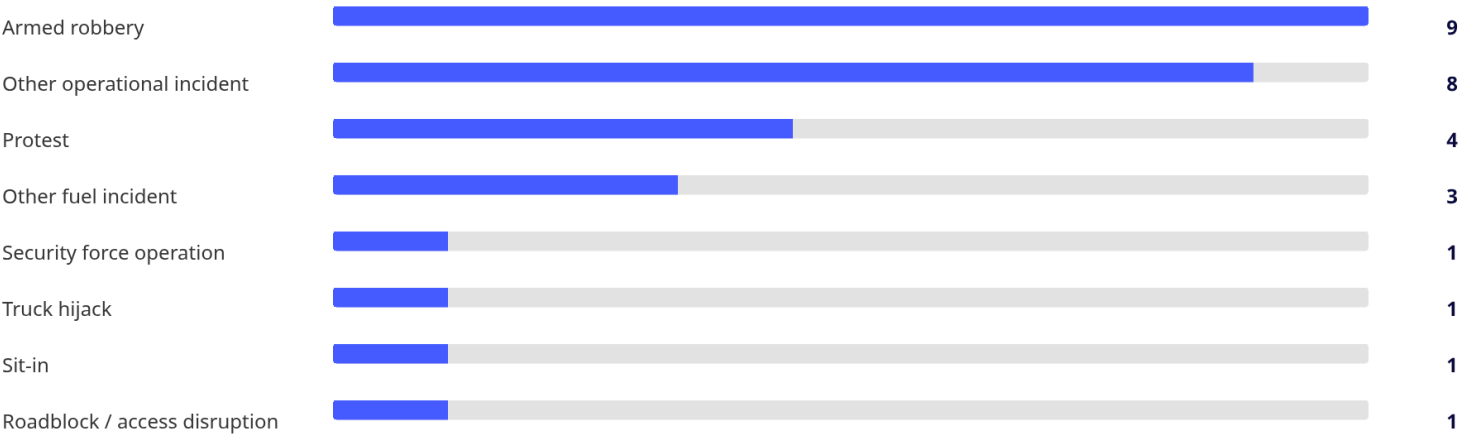


Records without coordinates are included in totals and tables but not plotted on the map. 10 of 30 records excluded from the map.
The map reflects the active reporting window — 30 30-day records. It is not the full risk picture — read it alongside the 30 / 90-day context sections above.

SEVERITY DISTRIBUTION



INCIDENT BREAKDOWN BY TYPE



WATCH NEXT

- Repeat armed-robbery or violent-crime activity in Port Moresby or Lae.
- Copycat or cluster activity around commercial premises, banks and cash-handling sites.
- Police response, arrests or any visible RPNGC posture change in the affected districts.
- Movement disruption near markets, main roads or cash-handling points in the two cities.
- Any shift from urban opportunistic crime to route or corridor incidents.
- Highlands Highway or Lae corridor deterioration — ambush, landslide, tribal-fight closure or strike action.
- Fuel, port or road disruption surfacing in the 30-day context that could spill into the current cycle.

POLESTAR VIEW

PNG should be treated as a low-volume but high-friction operating environment. A quiet week does not equal low risk. The current incidents point to urban violent crime in Port Moresby and Lae, while the 30 / 90-day context keeps route security, Highlands instability and resource-sector exposure in view. Business users should focus on movement discipline, local security support, and clear escalation triggers for any staff or contractor travel.

RELATED INCIDENTS

DATE	TYPE	TITLE	SEVERITY
21 May 2026 00:00	Armed robbery	Lae armed robbery leaves three dead, two wounded; child hit by stray bullet	HIGH
21 May 2026 00:00	Armed robbery	Armed robbery at Manu Cash and Carry; one suspect shot by police during pursuit	MODERATE
19 May 2026 00:00	Other fuel incident	PNG CORE applauds PM Marape's leadership on fuel subsidy and industry dialogue	LOW
17 May 2026 00:00	Other fuel incident	Government extends Fuel Subsidy to shield citizens from Global price shock	MODERATE
13 May 2026 00:00	Security force operation	PNG Chiefs eye cross-code coup with Pritchard brothers	LOW
12 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Trade goods truck hijacked outside Lae	MODERATE
12 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Raskol cluster of armed robberies in Gerehu	MODERATE
12 May 2026 00:00	Truck hijack	Trade-goods truck hijacked outside Lae, Morobe police investigating organised crew	MODERATE
11 May 2026 00:00	Armed robbery	Coffee buying agent payroll holdup in Goroka	MODERATE
11 May 2026 00:00	Armed robbery	Lae trade-store payroll-day holdup, two staff hurt	HIGH
10 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Overnight break-in at Madang waterfront warehouse	LOW
10 May 2026 00:00	Armed robbery	Holdup of jewellery store in Boroko	MODERATE
09 May 2026 00:00	Sit-in	Protests held across Sindh over killing of JUI-F leader Maulana Idrees	HIGH
09 May 2026 00:00	Roadblock / access disruption	PMV passengers robbed on Mt Hagen approach	MODERATE
09 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Cash van ambushed at Waigani roundabout	HIGH
08 May 2026 00:00	Armed robbery	Holdup of food-delivery rider in Hohola	MODERATE
08 May 2026 00:00	Protest	JUI-F holds second round of protests over killing of Maulana Idrees	MODERATE
08 May 2026 00:00	Protest	Public-sector workers march on parliament over pay arrears	MODERATE
07 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Container break-in at Lae port-adjacent yard	MODERATE

06 May 2026 00:00	Protest	JUI-F holds protest rallies across Khyber Pakhtunkhwa over killing of Maulana Idrees	HIGH
06 May 2026 00:00	Armed robbery	Late-night holdup at Jacksons long-stay carpark	HIGH
06 May 2026 00:00	Armed robbery	Bank cash-in-transit van held up at Waigani roundabout	HIGH
06 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Security forces ambushed during firearm recovery operation in Enga, one soldier wounded	HIGH
05 May 2026 00:00	Armed robbery	Holdup at downtown POM jewellery store	HIGH
04 May 2026 00:00	Other cargo incident	Warehouse heist in Port Moresby's Gerehu logistics zone, electronics consignment stolen	MODERATE
04 May 2026 00:00	Other fuel incident	@TheLastHopeUSA: 🇦🇪 UAE Targeted Today Iranian drones struck a petroleum facility in Fujairah and it made a fire. UAE air defenses intercepted 3 Iranian lo...	LOW
04 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Six Mile gang fight spills onto Hubert Murray Highway	MODERATE
02 May 2026 00:00	Protest	Coffee growers stage Goroka rally over export levy	MODERATE
01 May 2026 00:00	Container theft	Container theft at Lae inland freight depot, Morobe police investigating	MODERATE
01 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Truckload of trade-store stock stolen near Lae industrial area	MODERATE

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